

Learning objectives of the proseminars

BA Politics – Public Administration – Management, University of Konstanz

Last update: 28.01.2025

In proseminars, students develop basic skills in the area of academic work. These competences are promoted continuously and consecutively in proseminars I and proseminars II:

1. **Proseminars I „Basics of academic writing“** introduce students to the basic techniques of academic work and the handling of academic literature.
2. **Proseminars II „Advanced academic writing“** focus more strongly on writing skills, including the written elaboration of research questions, theories and hypotheses.

The teaching of academic skills is embedded in a subject-specific topic and supplemented by self-study units in ILIAS and teaching sessions with staff from the KIM and the Writing Centre.

To ensure that students in the different proseminars have similar learning conditions, all proseminars I and II pursue the same qualification goals in the area of academic work, which are listed below. Teachers are asked to take these learning objectives into account when organising their proseminars.

Proseminar I “Basics of academic writing” (summer semester)

After completing the proseminar, students have the following competences in the area of academic work. The students...

- can formulate a subject-specific topic and a precise research question for their literature research;
- can effectively research the relevant scientific sources, e.g. relevant academic literature;
- can explain the meaning and functions of a reference management software and integrate it into their writing process;
- are able to critically analyse academic texts;
- can create excerpts or response papers of scientific texts;
- can explain the procedure for writing academic papers and design an appropriate structure for a seminar paper in the form of a literature review;
- can explain and apply the usual citation rules and the formal requirements in the subject area, that need to be considered when writing a scientific paper;

- can design presentations that are substantiated in content, well-structured and visually appealing;
- are able to elaborate the state of research on a chosen research question from a given area and to independently write a seminar paper in the form of a literature review, taking into account the usual requirements and rules in the subject area.

The subject-specific learning objectives can be added by the teachers.

Proseminar II “Advanced academic writing” (winter semester)

After completing the proseminar, students have the following competences in the area of academic work. The students...

- can formulate an independent research question for their academic work;
- can formulate and justify a research hypothesis and a theory on their research topic;
- are able to identify and formulate a relevant research gap within their subject area and connect their own research question with the previous research;
- can independently design an appropriate structure for a scientific paper;
- are able to reflect on their own writing process and develop strategies to improve their academic texts;
- can create a short exposé/outline for a scientific paper;
- are able to make appropriate suggestions for improving the research projects or drafts of scientific texts of others;
- are able to independently write a seminar paper in the form of a detailed exposé, including the development of theory and hypotheses and taking into account the usual requirements and rules in the subject area.

The subject-specific learning objectives can be added by the teachers.